

Blu-ray sales double

Blu-ray sales have been seen an increase in doubling ever year

GPU-powered Office 2010

Microsoft's Office 2010 suite to be accelerated by AMD's GPUs including those integrated on motherboards

dows Mobile 6.5, but it is not shipping in that condition yet.

The interface is easy to use, and a task switcher/manager can be called up by holding the menu button. The Samsung TouchWiz UI is up to the task, and lets you interact with the devices well, with good haptic feedback, onscreen keyboards (alphanumeric and QWERTY), kinetic scrolling, and responsiveness for a resistive screen. The dedicated lock button is useful and well-placed, but, you are required to hold to unlock an onscreen icon for too long, resulting in some wasted time.

The 5MP cameras are okay, producing images that have relatively little noise and good crispness. The flash

Nuvifone M10 earphones made for good audio quality, while the loudspeaker was excellent, offering a rich sound both in voice calls and audio/video playback. Video playback was unfortunately marginally hampered by the 65K colour limitation of the OS, with gradients dithering a bit. It played everything without any stuttering however. Battery life is also excellent for a phone with such a large and bright screen, with it lasting more than two days on single charge, with frequent calls, video playback, and Bluetooth/Wi-Fi usage.

The B7610 OmniaPro has the 'pro' moniker because of its horizontal-sliding QWERTY keyboard form factor. Unfortunately, this makes the

times, whether closed or open. The four-row keyboard is easy to use though, and the buttons are well-placed.

The biggest disadvantages we've seen are their unexpectedly poor sunlight legibility, and the OmniaPros's lack of Flash support.

Samsung B7610 OmniaPro Verdict:

There is not much wrong with the device, and with its good battery life and media support, beautiful AMOLED screen, speedy interface and decent camera, you'd be hard-pressed to find a better horizontal sliding QWERTY phone that's priced much lower. Compared to the N97 Mini, the phone only lags behind in a few places: video quality, tilted screen (when keyboard is slid-out), free turn-by-turn voice navigation, and 16 million colours.

Samsung I8000 Omnia II Verdict:

The I8000 Omnia II manages to offer the same great functionalities of the OmniaPro, even without a QWERTY keyboard. Heads up against the Xperia X10 though, the phone lags behind. With a more responsive capacitive touchscreen and a fresher interface, the Xperia X10 is limited to 65K colours because of its Android 1.6 OS,

just like the Omnia II's Windows Mobile 6.1 OS. Both the phones' video playback and image display quality are hampered, with some visible dithering/banding. Android Marketplace also comes straight out of the box with the Xperia X10, but you'll have to make do with Java apps on the Omnia II unless you upgrade to Windows Mobile 6.5. One also has to remember the Xperia X10's better 8.1MP camera.

Sony Ericsson W995

It has a typical 'Walkman series' design: well laid out body contours with metallic Walkman control buttons on either side of the mobile and basic function buttons on the front panel. The phone has an elegant way to open the battery cover. Pull the media-stand (useful feature!), push up the lock button and the cover comes off - nice and easy.

The Walkman control buttons and the basic function buttons have a soft spring-like mechanism and produce true tactile feedback and input response when pressed. All the control buttons and keypad keys are conveniently spaced for comfortable finger movements and inputs. The keypad design is well laid-out with adequate spacing, and scores decent marks in the keypad test. The other notable thing is



Samsung B7610 OmniaPro

works well, and settings are plentiful enough to satisfy the amateur photographer. The phone's 480p (640x480) video recording was good in our tests, but did have some pixellation happening. Call clarity was good across the board, but we unfortunately did not get to test the bundled earphones because our test unit arrived without them. Using the good

OmniaPro quite bulky, with a 16.2mm width. However, the phone does fit well enough in your hand, though your pocket will be a bit strained. Its build quality is excellent, with its buttons offering great tactile response, the QWERTY keyboard included. The horizontal sliding keyboard has no lock, which makes for some slight movement in your hands at all



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